

The Weapons of Our Warfare

It is a time when we need to walk closer to the Spirit than we ever have in our lives. Woe to the peoples, teachers, and organizations that are not teaching people to do so.

I am grieved in my spirit because of some of the counseling sessions I have been having lately with preachers. I have watched what the devil has done to take their lives and ministries apart.

As the Lord began to minister to me, I heard different things through the grapevine, and I understand that Satan has launched an all-out attack upon the body of Christ, particularly in the United States, because she is a bloodline for the gospel, freedom of religion, and prosperity. There are people involved with witchcraft who are fasting and praying, what we would call chanting, to the prince of darkness, the head of his body, Satan, for the failure of the family unit, the destruction of children, the destruction of marriages, and the destruction of the morality of good Christian men and women.

He has been in an all-out attack that began at least a generation ago. He has been successful in this last generation because of the media. Like no other tool he has ever had, the media assists him in beginning the thought processes that are uncaptured thoughts. Those thoughts result in high things that exalt themselves against the knowledge of God, and those result in imaginations empowered by emotion until a man is put into a stronghold that Paul said needs a weapon of God to pull it down.

Most of the preachers I have counseled, and most good moral family men and women who have fallen, fell because they underestimated their enemy. They underestimated his militaristic, plotting, scheming ability to plan the demise of a Christian body of believers into immorality. They underestimated his subtlety and power to deceive.

When they finally fell into the mess, they still did not understand that it was the final step of a plan masterminded and carried out with the efficiency of the Roman Empire and its governments. They think, "I fell." They did not just fall. It was the last step in an organized plan.

This is why Jesus warned us to be wise as serpents and harmless as doves. A serpent, when it strikes, has no intention of leaving you alive. It strikes to kill. It is cunning, sneaky, and quiet. It gets its prey because the prey does not know it is there. When Jesus said, "Wise as a serpent," He meant we must understand deceptive, cunning, crafty stalking.

If you do not understand your enemy, how are you going to stand?

Some Christians are afraid to talk about the enemy. "I am not giving any glory to the enemy." I am not going to be foolish and deny everything he is doing, hoping that will make him go away. It will not.

Jesus said to be wise as a serpent and harmless as a dove because most of Satan's arsenal can only be combated by the wisdom that comes down from above. James says the wisdom from beneath is sensual and devilish, but the wisdom from above is pure, peaceable, gentle, and easy to be entreated.

That is why Paul said:

Be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might.

Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.

The only way you shift your strength to His strength is by putting on the armor. The armor is the power of His might. That is where your strength comes from.

I know that in circles where we have taught on standing and carnality, some Christians got up in the morning and dressed themselves in the armor: putting on the sandals of the preparation of the gospel of peace, slipping on the breastplate of righteousness, buckling up the sword of the Spirit, putting on the helmet of salvation, and girding their loins with truth.

That is not what he is talking about.

The armor is the wisdom that came down from above. The breastplate of righteousness is the revelation of your righteousness. If you understand it, you can stand in it, and Satan cannot penetrate it. It is not merely walking around saying, "I am the righteousness of God in Christ," though you are. It is understanding that Satan has nothing powerful enough to remove your righteousness if you do not let him.

So he has to introduce uncaptured thoughts through the media or through any other system he has available. He tries to confuse you so he can come around that righteousness with legalism or anything else and defeat you.

I am not going through the whole armor, but I am making a point.

When Paul says your feet are shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace, I used to think that meant I had to run around preaching peace to every sinner I saw. That is true collectively from the Word, but in relation to a Roman sandal, he was talking about ruggedness. Roman sandals were designed to survive forced marches through rocks, rivers, and every kind of terrain. When the soldier faced the enemy, they were designed to dig in and hold ground.

If the devil can come through uncaptured thoughts and the cares of this life to indoctrinate you into worries, torments, and fears, he has removed your sandals and you cannot stand anymore. The preparation of the gospel of peace is designed for you to stand against his wiles.

If he can get your sandals off, it is hard to stand.

If I do not understand how my enemy works, I will end up another religion. He will talk me out of the gifts of the Spirit, then out of everyone being baptized in the Holy Ghost, then out of salvation, and finally into a social club. He does not care if it takes three generations. He will neutralize me, the move I started, you, your children, or the move they started, if we do not understand his tactics.

Yes, I want to understand my enemy and how he works.

I am grieved, not that my peace is gone, but because I am only steps away from sliding in and out of intercession for these people. The whole reason they failed is that they underestimated their enemy.

Paul says:

The weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds.

The stronghold he is talking about is a prison. It locks a man's life up. He says the weapons of our warfare are mighty through God, and Ephesians says to put on the whole armor so you may stand against the wiles of the enemy. Our weapons are mighty through God because they are the things Jesus purchased for us: righteousness, salvation, peace, truth, and the Word.

The helmet of salvation protects my mind against legalism. The law was always attempting to penetrate the early church, but I am justified.

It makes you wonder: what kind of stronghold, what kind of prison, could the devil erect that would require a weapon specifically designed by God to pull it down? If you did not have God's weaponry, what chance would you have of storming that stockade?

Paul tells us what the stronghold consists of:

Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ.

That is the prison. It consists of the way a man thinks.

This is why so much of Paul's revelation revolved around putting off the old man and being renewed in the spirit of your mind after the inner man in true holiness. Romans 12 says:

Be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind.

Half of Paul's gospel revolved around being delivered from old ways of thinking through transformation, so that you take on the mind of Christ. That is where your liberty lies.

To him that believes, all things are possible, and nothing shall be impossible to you. Why can I not believe? Because my thoughts are wrong.

If the apostle Paul warned that this is a prison, then it is a prison. God knows how many times He has told me to warn you that the Islamic world is locked up in a prison. There are no steel bars holding them. It is all in their mind. The African mind with paganism and witchcraft is another flavor of religion, another deception by principalities. The Oriental mind with its wise-men philosophies searches for life and misses the one standard that did not even come from this planet.

You have a copy of that standard in your lap. The faster you transform to it, the better off you will be.

All the wisdom every nation has to offer, if it did not come down from above, is from beneath, sensual, and devilish. The wisdom from above is first pure, then peaceable, gentle, and easy to be entreated. It is the only standard of truth, not only in this galaxy, but in the entire universe. If you conform to anything else, you are in for a bad ride.

If the Word of God says to speak in tongues, then speak in tongues.

The Western mind thinks it is so smart. We are the leading nation. We have pride. We think we have the answers to the world's problems. Thank God for the United States, because we feed many people and give so much to the gospel. But the devil has continually attempted to penetrate all our forces in the United States.

One of the most sensual, hellbound things he has brought is New Age philosophy: new age, old devil.

The prison is in the mind. The difference between you and a multimillionaire who got out and made his millions is not the millions. It is where each of you chose to stop in your own personal prison.

My heart has been grieved. I have been in and out of the corner of intercession for many friends who have been deceived and fallen into traps of the enemy simply because they underestimated him.

I said, "Lord, if I am to be wise as a serpent, I need to understand completely how the devil does this." I know the devil does not just walk up and capture everybody suddenly so they fall into immorality. He has to use a system.

First come uncaptured thoughts. They graduate into high things, continually hammering and exalting themselves against the knowledge of God and what you know the Word says, with the full intention of unseating God's knowledge and replacing it with themselves. Finally they become imaginations that have no foundation of truth and are empowered by emotionalism. Then they enslave the man.

Have you ever wondered why things come in waves? All of a sudden everybody seems to be getting a divorce, both in the church and outside it. Divorce rises to an all-time high. In one nation the devil will starve people to death; in another he will demoralize them. He uses these same tactics on the world and the body of believers.

How does a person fall to this kind of immorality? What takes the desire out of him so he does not want to fight for his marriage anymore?

It does not start suddenly. It starts with unchecked, uncaptured thoughts that graduate into high things. First they are temptations thrown your way. If you do not deal with them properly, they conceive and become lusts. Then they take on power and become high things that war against what you know to be the knowledge of God in your life.

The prison consists of imaginations. An imagination is a way of thinking that has no foundation of truth, like the indoctrination of an Islamic soldier. He is enslaved in it, and if you try to get him out of it, he may kill you. It is in his mind.

You sit here as Christian people, and it is only the mercy of God that you were born in America, sitting here born again and getting filled with the Word. You could have been born in another place and indoctrinated by your elders.

We are talking about a prison.

When we think of a demon-possessed person, we often think of some raving maniac, and many have been reduced to that. But that is the final stage. They do not start like that.

Do you think all devils are maniacs that prey on people in graveyards? No. Some people are highly possessed, as possessed as they can be, and these unclean spirits are instructed to hide behind flamboyant personalities. The devil gets them into high places, educational structures, and media.

Where do you think the magazines, media, and articles come from that take the morals of the family unit backward one step at a time and make it acceptable? It is acceptable because five PhDs are behind the devil.

Who chooses the programming that comes into your homes through television? If the devil is going to seduce a generation, he will use flamboyant personalities and get them into key places like media and education. They start the uncaptured-thought business in the privacy of homes, where people lend themselves in the soul realm to more and more junk until it pushes their emotional line of right and wrong so far back that it begins to war against the knowledge of God.

Then your demise is starting, and you are not even wise enough to know who is taking you apart.

Where do you think pornography comes from? How do you think the devil fights legislation against it? Who pushes the line of immorality back? What is it all heading for but high things, until finally good moral businessmen and women in the church lend themselves to so much of this visual stimulation that it creates emotional flows and starts warring against their souls?

It does not matter how beautiful a man's wife is. The thing is not logical anymore. It starts fueling lust. The healthy relationship between a man and his wife leaves acceptable limits and starts being fueled by lust. This spirit demands sacrifice, and it will not rest until he runs after other women.

The person is being taken apart.

When Ed Cole preached "Maximized Manhood" in one of Kenneth Copeland's conventions, many preachers came forward for lasciviousness and filthiness of the flesh involving pornography and the abuse of their own bodies.

The person enslaved in this kind of thing feels trapped. Many lift their hands, worship God outwardly, pray over meals, hold church positions, and stand in good reputation. They get trapped because they cannot tell the people closest to them, the people who respect them, have faith in them, and love them. So they do not want to hurt the people around them.

If you only knew how many preachers I have had to counsel.

Have you wondered why these things come in waves? The devil started plotting the demise of this generation decades ago, and the media helped him tremendously.

He gathers his principalities over the United States and tells them to take every unclean spirit under their command, and if necessary powers, rulers of darkness, and untold millions of unclean spirits, and to begin simultaneously breaking down the morals of the body of Christ. "Specialize in divorce among preachers, the breakup of marriages, and the immorality of the saints."

So the unclean spirits begin manipulating people into high places to affect your thinking through media, education, and literature in your homes. The process begins. When one wave subsides, the devil begins the momentum of another one and preys on another set of human weaknesses.

The devil is too stupid to originate anything. The only thing he originated was sin, his rebellion against God. But he is smart enough to know that the system God used to get us into the kingdom can also be reversed to keep people in Satan's kingdom or re-indoctrinate believers into bondage.

God said:

How shall they hear without a preacher?

You came in as a sinner, heard the Word, saw the life and example of the preacher and the people, and your thought process started changing. You believed Jesus was real, accepted Him, and were born again. Then teachers came, and the transformation of the soul began until you were set free.

The devil knew that if he reversed that process, he could enslave you again.

You and I exist on three planes: spirit, soul, and body.

My spirit loves to fellowship with God. It is seated in heavenly places with Christ Jesus, and the ache in my heart cannot be quenched outside of fellowship with my Father. Worship helps. Praying in tongues helps. My spirit demands fellowship with someone I cannot even see, and you know it. There is nothing on earth like it when your soul is in fellowship with your spirit.

My spirit was designed to fellowship with God, to commune with Him. It cannot live without it. That is why people in religion have dried up. Nothing will feed your spirit except the presence of God, His mysteries, His Word, His mind, and your salvation relationship with Him.

We have been starved so badly in many circles that our poor spirits are dried up, and our souls are at the mercy of the world. All we have left is double standards.

My spirit demands fellowship with God, but my soul is called my soul because it is mine. It demands socialization. That is why God created Eve. It is not good for man to live alone. My soul demands fellowship with other people. It is a social thing.

This is why, when preachers discover that socialization of souls will cause their church to grow, they shove the Word of God into a fifteen-minute slot and create every kind of program they can think of. Youth, singles, married couples, elderly groups, and anything else. We get together and socialize. We tell about our achievements and exploits. It is socialization.

But when you let that replace the operation of the Spirit in the church, you have signed the failure warrant for a whole church full of people. It will not hold you when hell falls. You must have more to draw on. The root system has to come from the spirit.

God created my soul uniquely. It will socialize and transform to its surroundings. If I am in an agricultural region, my soul will conform to that knowledge and ability. Put me in the tundra, and eventually I will learn to live there, because my soul has the power to socialize and transform to its surroundings.

Consequently, the devil knows that indoctrination tool is as powerful for him as it was for God. All he has to do is pipe socialization into your soul through television, media, the printed page, and the educational system. Eventually you will socialize, adapt, and become unless you get into fellowship with God.

My soul is created by God to conform to what I willfully submit myself to.

David Wilkerson prophesied years ago that a day would come when dirty movies would be piped into the homes of clergy so that, in the privacy of their rooms, they could be taken apart. Now through satellites and communication systems, everything the devil wants you to know can be put into every nook, cranny, and village.

The devil knows God has the system: hearing through a preacher, indoctrination first of the soul, the born-again experience, then the walk in the Spirit to the transformation of the soul, and finally the walk with God. He knows that if you do not get transformation, he can start the process over and put you in a stronghold. You may hate yourself, but you will be in it nevertheless.

I would reverse the process. The same thing will get you out of poverty. Start captivating your mind with God's thoughts.

This is why Augie David's testimony is so important. When the strong man came through indoctrination and tried to take Augie apart, most of his salvation was that he read the Word of God from cover to cover every two weeks for a solid year. It took him up to six hours a day.

He traded in the thoughts the enemy was using to disassemble him for God's thoughts. Your emotions cannot stay out of sync with God when you pour His thoughts through your spirit for six hours a day. You cannot even stay broke.

When a person is in a stronghold of imagination, you must understand that his emotions are gone. Way down in his spirit, he wants to serve God, but the rest of him feels there is no hope. He has gone up and bawled, repented, done everything the deliverance preacher said, had hands laid on him, counseled privately, promised not to tell anybody, gone out believing he was free, and fallen right back into the same pit.

We have had international ministries testify to this. They fell in front of everybody. Before criticizing them, you need to understand what got them in. If you know what got them in, you know what will get them out.

Reverse the process. Your soul will do it. Your spirit will starve to death if your soul does not take in the information to feed it.

I did not know what to do with some of the preachers until I heard Augie's testimony.

I would say, "Pray in the Holy Ghost."

"I do not feel like it."

"How about worshiping God?"

"I do not want to. Why should I go into a closet and worship God? I would rather do the other stuff."

"Then why are you counseling with me?"

"Because I want to be free. I just do not have the strength to do it. I am gone. I am finished."

I sat there praying when one preacher had been disassembled. Another pastor came to me and said he had just counseled someone at the altar who said the same thing.

I finally told him, "Will you read the Word of God for two hours a day? One hour in the Old Testament and one hour in the New Testament? When you get to the end, start over. Will you do that? No matter what kind of pit you crawl out of, will you get your Bible out and read it two hours?"

"But I do not feel worthy."

Forget the worthy feelings. If God's thoughts can flow through you a couple of hours a day, pretty soon they will start arresting the uncaptured thoughts. Keep doing it. Read it out loud. Let His thoughts run through you.

Read:

In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.

Read:

In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.

The same was in the beginning with God.

All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made.

In him was life; and the life was the light of men.

Hour after hour, let the thoughts of God pass through you, and an amazing thing will begin to happen. Those emotions you were looking for, the want-to, will slowly begin to creep back into your soul. At times when you finish reading, you will feel like worshiping. You will start feeling like praying. You will reverse the process and come back.

I just want to cry. I hurt so badly. It is a form of intercession. I have been hurt, but He talks to me about it, like He did this morning.

Good stuff. Amen.

Why don't you stand?